Suplementary File A. Case study selection criteria

	National Level	Regional Level			District Level (Positive Change)	District Level (Negative Change)
	Germany	**Niedersachsen (D9)**	**Lüneburg Region (D93)**	**MPR Hamburg**	**Lüneburg County (DE935)**	**Lüchow-Dannenberg (DE934)**
Population (2017 Estimate)	82792351	7962775	1703945	1830584	182930	48357
Land Area (km²)	357022	47593	15507	755	1324	1221
Density (/km²)	232	167.3	110	2424	138.2	39.61
NUTS1 - Region	16			1		
NUTS2 -Sub-Region	38	4				
NUTS3 - Districts	401	46	11			
Population Change (2011-2017)					43 Settelment	27 Settelment
Percentage of Age 65+		19.60%			+0.75% yearly	-0.62%
Percentage of Rural population		54%			54%	52%
Distance to city center					Distance to Hamburg 56 km	Distance to Hamburg 106 km
Elevation (m)					8m	13m
Morphology of town center					Centric	Linear
Near to waterbasin					Elbe	Elbe
	National Level	**Regional Level**			**District Level (Positive Change)**	**District Level (Negative Change)**
	Turkey	**West Marmara (TR2)**	**Trakya (TR 21)**	**MPR Istanbul**	**Lüleburgaz (LAU1)**	**Babaeski (LAU1)**
Population (2017 Estimate)	80810525	3503609	1690000	15029231	147325	48229
Land Area (km²)	769604	41280	18739	5196	1018	633
Density (/km²)	105	85	90	2892	144	76.14
NUTS1 - Region	12			1		
NUTS2 - Sub-Region	26	2				
NUTS3 - Province	81	5	3			
LAU1 - Districts	921	60	28		4 Small town + 31 village	Town center+31 Settlement
Population Change (2011-2017)					1.50%	-0.89%
Percentage of Age 65+					9.43%	15.50%
Percentage of Rural population					21%	39%
Distance to city center					Distance to Istanbul 150 km	Distance to Ambarlı 175 km
Elevation (m)					55m	55m
Morphology of town center					Centric	Centric
Near to waterbasin					Ergene	Ergene